8VC ATX Build Session - Oct. 15, 2026

Oct 14, 2026 · @Will Hayward

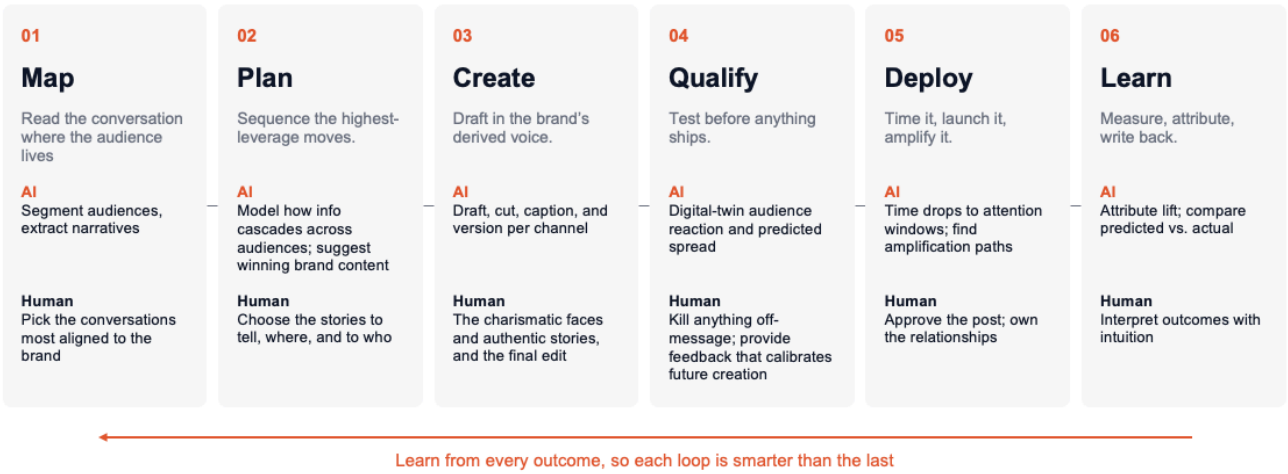
The Challenge

8VC is building new tools and strategies in the media realm. Today, we'll each build a agentic harness that enables a brand to near-autonomously orchestrate an intelligent media strategy.

We think about decision-making in the media space as another area to apply **the OODA loop** pioneered by US Air Force Colonel John Boyd in the 1970s to help pilots make quick decisions during aerial combat.

Brands need to **observe** real-time trends across the info sphere; **orient** their brand's mission and story within that environment; **decide** what content, modalities, and channels best amplify that story; and **act** in short timeframes as narratives and attention quickly shift. Just as compressing the OODA loop has allowed the US to win on the battlefield, we believe brands that do the same for media will reach relevant audiences and decision-makers more effectively than their competition.

Here's a frame on our extrapolation of the OODA loop to media, with work-in-progress ideas on a complementary division of labor between humans and AI:



Across the media loop, there are myriad utilities, tools, and workflows. Every day, empowered builders are selling new point solutions, frontier labs are launching new models with increasingly general intelligence, and the individuals responsible for driving their brand's media strategy struggle to keep up.

What does a self-evolving agentic harness for media look like? What tools, skills, memory, loops, and human-in-the-loop checkpoints does an effective media harness require?

The direction we're exploring is a harness around a flexible core that:

- Watches a brand's own material and activity to surface what's genuinely interesting
- Uses a chorus of AI "media minds" to propose how to tell the brand's stories
- Flexibly swaps in the best new tools as they appear and retires them when something better ships, using browser or computer use when no API is available
- Learns from what performs well and feeds that back into the next round

Tonight, we'll build a harness for a small-scale test case: running a fan account on X for the WNBA star and Iowa Hawkeye Caitlin Clark. The account currently runs on our in-house autonomous posting tool, and it's posting into the void: a few posts, two followers and a few replies. By the end of the night, your harness should recommend posts and other media actions to our agent; if they are good enough, our agent might decide to actually take those actions from the live account.

What you'll get

- **A mission file** for the account: who it's for, core subjects, tone, and goals. Humor and edge are welcome; rivalry banter beats generic praise.
- **A defined action space.** Original posts, replies, quote posts, mentions, follows. X only for tonight.
- **LLM credits** to build with.
- **No direct posting access.** Your harness recommends; our Grok bot, which runs the account, brokers what actually gets posted.

Ground rules

- Bring your laptop and charger. Wi-Fi and pizza are on us.
- We're building alongside you. Ask and propose anything--there are no bad ideas.
- Stay as long as you like, leave whenever you need to.
- If you think our framing is wrong, say so and build it your way.